CIVILS ATLAS / RESEARCH EDITION 18

February 2025

Understand the news.
Retain what matters.

82 study notes · 30 MCQs · Mains frameworks

UPSC × Andhra Pradesh APPSC · English
Research cut-off: 7 November 2026

Read the coverage contract

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

New notes separate reported facts from original static connections, analysis, cautions and Mains prompts. P1 = core; P2 = consolidation; P3 = selective factual recall. Broad AP relevance is not exact APPSC paper mapping. Read the research audit for omissions and unresolved claims.

Daily discovery is NOT activated: GitHub repository deployment or first scheduled execution is pending. Automation collects unreviewed source links, not researched study notes.

Source extracts are not whole-document reviews. November covers only 1–7 November. Review research/Research-Status.md before treating any month as complete.

Subject guide

Polity & Governance — 10 notes

Economy — 17 notes

Agriculture — 8 notes

Society & Welfare — 11 notes

Environment — 3 notes

Science & Technology — 8 notes

Security — 4 notes

International Relations — 6 notes

Andhra Pradesh — 12 notes

Culture & History — 2 notes

Awards & Sports — 1 notes

How to study

Read P1 → consolidate P2 → recall P3. Review after 1, 7 and 30 days. Explain each caution unaided. Build answers with a dated fact, mechanism, limitation and conclusion.

Sources and access provenance appear in the appendix. Original analysis is not a sourced prediction of exam questions.

Polity & Governance

03 · Welfare, elections & fiscal accountability

Welfare versus freebies: evaluate design, not labels

VM2502-001 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue revisited judicial observations on electoral promises and welfare. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Articles 38, 39 and 41 express welfare-oriented constitutional principles.

• Budget support can finance public services, insurance, transfers or consumption subsidies with different effects.

• An observation in a hearing is not necessarily a final binding finding about all welfare programmes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Public goods, merit goods, social protection and poorly targeted subsidies should not be reduced to a single undefined category.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Assess incidence, fiscal sustainability, administrative cost and demonstrable capability gains.

• AP welfare debates need expenditure and outcome evidence rather than assuming all transfers either eliminate poverty or discourage work.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not convert a judge’s observation into a universal causal finding that recipients stop working.

MAINS PROMPT What criteria distinguish sustainable social protection from fiscally irresponsible electoral promises?

Sources: [V2502-01]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

05 · Local self-government

Devolution Index: institutions need functions, finance and staff

VM2502-002 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined the Panchayati Raj Ministry/IIPA assessment. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The report evaluates state/UT devolution through six dimensions.

• Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu are the reported leading states.

• A constitutional institution may exist without equivalent operational control over funds and functionaries.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 243G and the Eleventh Schedule relate to panchayat responsibilities; actual devolution requires state legal and administrative action.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Compare practical planning powers and predictable finance rather than elections alone.

• AP local bodies need capacity, staffing, transparency and accountable discretion, not merely centrally or state-designed projects delivered through them.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-030, E5-2508-044, E5-2508-045, E7-2512-028, E7-2512-031, E7-2512-035, E8-2601-028, E8-2601-031 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION An index ranking is method- and period-dependent, not proof that every panchayat in a leading state is effective.

MAINS PROMPT Why does democratic decentralisation require more than regular local elections?

Sources: [V2502-02]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

09 · Judicial capacity

Supreme Court stays Lokpal’s HC-judge order

FEB25-027 · P1 · 2025-02-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS An interim intervention raised the balance between accountability and judicial independence.

• The Lokpal order asserting jurisdiction was dated 27 January.

• The Supreme Court stayed it on 20 February in suo motu proceedings.

• Notices and further consideration followed.

• The February milestone was interim, not a fully reasoned final determination of all issues.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Statutory anti-corruption jurisdiction and constitutional judicial status must be read together. Independence does not mean immunity from every accountability mechanism.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Legitimate scrutiny needs procedures protecting both public confidence and judges from harassment.

• A balanced answer should identify proper investigation, disciplinary and removal routes rather than infer total impunity from one stay.

PRELIMS CAUTION A stay suspends operation; it is not automatically final quashing or a declaration that no judge can ever face criminal process.

MAINS PROMPT How can judicial accountability be strengthened without weakening independent adjudication?

Sources: [F-LOKPAL]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

11 · Electoral participation

Delhi election: results and government formation

FEB25-029 · P2 · 2025-02-08 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Assembly result produced a change in government.

• BJP won 48 of 70 seats; AAP won 22.

• The results were declared on 8 February.

• Rekha Gupta took oath as Chief Minister on 20 February.

• Seat outcomes and the later appointment are distinct stages.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Delhi’s constitutional framework under Article 239AA differs from an ordinary state. A seat majority does not mean the same percentage of total votes.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use the event to revise electoral representation and Delhi’s institutional structure.

• Policy accountability should focus on service outcomes and lawful division of functions rather than partisan campaign claims.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse these Assembly results with municipal elections; one source’s live narrative contained that imprecise wording.

MAINS PROMPT How does Delhi’s special constitutional arrangement affect democratic accountability?

Sources: [F-DELHI], [F-DELHI2]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

CEC transition under the 2023 appointment law

FEB25-025 · P1 · 2025-02-19 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Gyanesh Kumar assumed charge after the February appointment notification.

• Gyanesh Kumar succeeded Rajiv Kumar as CEC.

• The appointment notification was dated 17 February; assumption was on 19 February.

• Vivek Joshi was appointed Election Commissioner.

• The appointments occurred amid pending legal debate over the selection framework.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 324 establishes the constitutional election institution. The 2023 selection law and judicial challenges to it are distinct from an assumption-of-office event.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Credible appointments require transparency, institutional independence and public confidence.

• Explain the legal framework and contested issues without equating an allegation with a judicial finding.

PRELIMS CAUTION Appointment date and charge-taking date differ. Do not describe the Chief Justice as a member of the statutory 2023 selection panel.

MAINS PROMPT What institutional safeguards strengthen both the independence and accountability of an election commission?

Sources: [F-CEC], [F-CEC2]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

12 · Cooperatives & institutions

Tribhuvan Sahkari University Bill

FEB25-008 · P2 · 2025-02-03 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The proposed university sought specialised education for the cooperative sector.

• The Bill proposed establishing IRMA, Anand, within the university framework.

• Objectives include cooperative education, training, research and capacity building.

• PRS describes a VC, executive council and governing board with central appointment roles.

• IRMA’s autonomous identity was to be preserved within the proposed structure.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Cooperative capability depends on member governance, accounts, professional management and market access—not institutional naming alone.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Sector-specific education can strengthen audit, logistics and digital skills.

• The design should preserve member-centred values and academic quality rather than substitute centralised administration for cooperative autonomy.

PRELIMS CAUTION A Bill introduced on 3 February is not proof the university was fully operational or every programme accredited that month.

MAINS PROMPT How can professionalisation strengthen cooperatives without weakening democratic member control?

Sources: [F-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

13 · Land records & spatial governance

National Geospatial Mission proposed

FEB25-024 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed foundational spatial infrastructure and data.

• The mission was intended to support land-record modernisation.

• Urban planning and infrastructure design were identified uses.

• The speech linked the work with PM Gati Shakti.

• This proposal is broader than one urban land-survey pilot.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Geospatial data combine location with attributes. Mapping accuracy, interoperability, privacy and legal validity are distinct concerns.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Shared spatial evidence can reduce planning duplication and improve network decisions.

• Accountable access, current datasets and transparent correction are essential when maps influence property and public investment.

PRELIMS CAUTION The National Geospatial Mission, NAKSHA and SVAMITVA are related but not interchangeable names.

MAINS PROMPT How can spatial-data infrastructure improve public investment while protecting citizens' rights?

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

NAKSHA: urban land-record pilot

FEB25-013 · P1 · 2025-02-18 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The pilot launched with aerial mapping and field validation.

• NAKSHA stands for National Geospatial Knowledge-based Land Survey of Urban Habitations.

• The announced pilot covered 152 ULBs across 26 states and three UTs.

• The launch was at Raisen, Madhya Pradesh; the approximate central cost was ₹194 crore.

• Survey of India provides technical support; states undertake ground verification.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Urban record mapping is distinct from rural abadi mapping under SVAMITVA. Geometry, possession and legally established ownership are not automatically the same.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Mapping can support planning, taxation and transparent transactions.

• Public objections, correction procedures and safeguards for tenants/informal residents are necessary to avoid digitising existing inequities.

PRELIMS CAUTION A pilot is not nationwide completed coverage. A high-resolution map does not by itself finally adjudicate every title dispute.

MAINS PROMPT How can urban land digitisation improve governance without increasing exclusion?

Sources: [F-NAKSHA], [F-NAKSHA2]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

14 · Federalism & constitutional safeguards

Tamil Nadu Governor case: judgment reserved

FEB25-028 · P1 · 2025-02-10 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Court completed February hearings over delayed assent to Bills.

• The bench reserved judgment on 10 February, as reported the next day.

• The dispute concerned Governor action under Article 200.

• Repassed Bills and later reservation for the President were central issues.

• The later April judgment is not a February holding.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 200 concerns assent, withholding, return and reservation in the constitutional framework. Oral arguments, judicial questions and a final ratio are different.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Indefinite delay can frustrate elected lawmaking and invite constitutional deadlock.

• Study institutional role and remedy without treating a party’s courtroom argument as settled law.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not backdate April’s timelines or deemed-assent relief to February; later references and rulings also need current-law review.

MAINS PROMPT Why do constitutional offices require both formal powers and conventions of timely action?

Sources: [F-TNGOV]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

President’s Rule in Manipur

FEB25-026 · P1 · 2025-02-13 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The proclamation followed the Chief Minister’s resignation during a prolonged crisis.

• President’s Rule was imposed on 13 February.

• N. Biren Singh had resigned four days earlier.

• The Assembly was placed under suspended animation.

• The notification invoked Article 356.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 356 concerns failure of constitutional machinery. Suspended animation differs from dissolution; parliamentary approval and constitutional limits remain relevant.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Union administration may be justified as a temporary response but is not a substitute for restoring representative government.

• Peace-building requires security, relief, rehabilitation, accountability and trust across communities.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call this a national emergency under Article 352 or assume the Assembly was automatically dissolved.

MAINS PROMPT How should constitutional intervention be combined with a credible path back to representative government?

Sources: [F-MANIPUR]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Economy

01 · Fiscal policy

Union Budget 2025–26: fiscal anchor

CA-001 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Union Budget was presented on 1 February.

• Total expenditure BE: ₹50.65 lakh crore; non-borrowing receipts: ₹34.96 lakh crore.

• Fiscal deficit BE: 4.4% of GDP; capital expenditure: ₹11.21 lakh crore (3.1% of GDP).

• Revenue deficit was estimated at 1.5% of GDP; all these FY2025–26 figures are Budget Estimates, not audited outcomes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Fiscal deficit measures the borrowing gap; revenue deficit concerns the revenue account. Capital expenditure is not automatically high-quality investment.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Interest payments absorb a substantial share of spending and limit room for other priorities.

• Assess capex through project quality, execution and maintenance, not only its share of GDP.

PRELIMS CAUTION Budget estimates are planned figures, not actual spending.

MAINS PROMPT Explain the growth–fiscal consolidation trade-off. Use capex quality, multiplier effects and debt sustainability.

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

02 · Taxation

New-regime personal income-tax relief

CA-003 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Budget tax proposals changed the new-regime slabs and rebate.

• Budget announced no personal income tax up to ₹12 lakh of eligible income under the new regime, excluding special-rate income such as capital gains.

• For salaried taxpayers, the stated threshold was ₹12.75 lakh with ₹75,000 standard deduction.

• The rebate-based relief and the standard deduction are separate mechanisms; special-rate income requires separate treatment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A nil slab, rebate, deduction and special-rate income have different legal effects.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Tax relief can support disposable income but affects only households within its scope.

• Judge distribution, consumption response and revenue cost; check operative law before using thresholds as personal tax advice.

PRELIMS CAUTION This is not a blanket nil-rate slab up to ₹12 lakh; distinguish slab, deduction and rebate. Historical budget position, not current tax advice.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate consumption stimulus against revenue foregone and distributional effects.

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Income-Tax Bill 2025: introduction, not enactment

FEB25-004 · P1 · 2025-02-13 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS A new Bill sought to replace the Income-Tax Act, 1961 and was referred to a Select Committee.

• The February Bill retained most substantive provisions and did not itself recast individual/corporate tax rates.

• It proposed a 1 April 2026 commencement.

• It addressed virtual digital assets in undisclosed income and access to virtual digital space during search proceedings.

• New scheme-making powers and parliamentary laying requirements were described by PRS.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A tax-code replacement Bill and the annual Finance Bill are different instruments. Introduction, passage, assent and commencement are separate stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Simpler drafting can reduce compliance uncertainty but must be tested against actual taxpayer experience.

• Expanded digital-search powers raise necessity, scope, privacy and remedy questions beyond the goal of language simplification.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-002, E5-2508-003, E13-2606-007

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not attribute February’s tax slabs to this replacement Bill rather than the Budget/Finance Bill. Later withdrawal or replacement versions must be traced separately.

MAINS PROMPT How can tax simplification preserve enforceability while limiting discretionary intrusion?

Sources: [F-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

03 · Industry & MSMEs

MSME classification: proposed expansion

CA-008 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Budget proposed revised MSME classification thresholds.

• Budget proposed enhancing investment limits by 2.5 times and turnover limits by 2 times for MSME classification.

• The investment and turnover criteria are separate components of the composite enterprise classification.

• The February announcement preceded the March notification and 1 April effective date, which are tracked in a separate March note.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Investment and turnover tests are separate; classification affects access to selected schemes but does not remove every lending condition.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Higher thresholds can reduce the incentive to remain artificially small.

• Support must still reach micro firms with weaker collateral and bargaining power.

PRELIMS CAUTION The multipliers differ. The notification and effective date must be checked separately.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate whether threshold revision improves scale without weakening support for small firms.

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

MSME credit package: guarantees and micro credit cards

FEB25-015 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed distinct credit tools for different enterprise segments.

• Guarantee cover was proposed to rise from ₹5 crore to ₹10 crore for micro/small enterprises.

• For start-ups, the proposed cover rose from ₹10 crore to ₹20 crore.

• Exporter MSMEs were assigned a separate proposed cover up to ₹20 crore.

• Ten lakh Udyam-registered micro-enterprise credit cards with ₹5 lakh limits were envisaged in the first year.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A credit-card limit, guaranteed-loan cover and an investment-classification threshold are different numbers. None is an unconditional cash transfer.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Different instruments address working-capital, collateral and export-finance constraints.

• Evaluation needs additional viable lending, borrower cost, defaults and access by truly small firms.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not mix this Budget package with January’s separate machinery guarantee scheme or treat ten lakh cards as already issued.

MAINS PROMPT How can enterprise-finance policy improve access without hiding contingent public liabilities?

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

06 · Growth, inflation & statistics

RBI cuts the repo rate to 6.25%

FEB25-001 · P1 · 2025-02-07 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The February MPC reduced the policy rate by 25 basis points while retaining a neutral stance.

• Repo moved from 6.50% to 6.25%.

• Standing Deposit Facility moved to 6.00%.

• MSF and Bank Rate moved to 6.50%.

• The MPC maintained the 4% inflation-target focus while supporting growth.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The repo rate is a policy instrument, not every borrower’s contracted loan rate. Transmission depends on funding costs, loan benchmarks and bank balance sheets.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• A cut can support demand and reduce some debt-service costs, but transmission is uneven and not instantaneous.

• A neutral stance is not a promise of uninterrupted future cuts; incoming inflation and growth evidence remains relevant.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS APR25-003, E5-2506-001, E5-2508-001, E5-2508-006, E6-2510-001, E6-2510-002, E7-2511-001, E7-2512-001 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION 25 basis points is 0.25 percentage point, not a 25% rate cut. These are February rates, not current rates.

MAINS PROMPT Why may a repo-rate cut fail to translate into an equally large immediate reduction in all lending rates?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-RBI]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

Industrial production: December and Q3 readings

FEB25-003 · P2 · 2025-02-12 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The monthly release completed the October–December industrial picture.

• December 2024 IIP growth was 3.2%.

• PRS computed Q3 growth at 3.9%, compared with 6.1% a year earlier.

• Q3 manufacturing grew 4.3%, mining 1.8%, electricity 4.1%.

• Manufacturing carries about 78% of the IIP weight.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL IIP measures physical output movements in selected industries. It is not identical to manufacturing GVA or the whole economy’s GDP.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Compare broad groups and use categories to examine whether capital-goods and consumer demand are strengthening.

• A positive but slower growth rate means expansion at a reduced pace, not necessarily contraction.

PRELIMS CAUTION 3.2% is the December monthly reading; 3.9% is the quarterly average growth described by PRS. Do not substitute one for the other.

MAINS PROMPT Why should policymakers use IIP alongside GDP, employment and business surveys rather than as a standalone verdict?

Sources: [F-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

GDP: Q3 growth and the second advance estimate

FEB25-002 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS MoSPI’s release revised both current-year projections and earlier-year estimates.

• Real Q3 FY2024–25 GDP growth was 6.2%, versus 9.5% in the corresponding prior-year quarter at this vintage.

• The second advance FY2024–25 growth estimate was 6.5%, versus January’s 6.4%.

• FY2023–24 growth was revised from 8.2% to 9.2%.

• Q3 agriculture GVA grew 5.6%; manufacturing 3.5%.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A statistical vintage matters: revisions alter historical comparisons. Quarterly year-on-year growth, annual growth and sequential growth are distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Use this note to understand why January’s and February’s prior-year numbers differ without assuming one was fabricated.

• Sector differences suggest targeted productivity and investment questions, rather than treating aggregate recovery as uniform prosperity.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not mix January’s unrevised 8.2% prior-year figure with February’s revised series without disclosure. These are not certified latest-series values.

MAINS PROMPT How should statistical revisions change economic analysis and public communication?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-GDP]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

08 · Financial inclusion & markets

Insurance FDI: conditional Budget proposal

FEB25-023 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed increasing the foreign-investment limit.

• The proposed limit was 100%, up from 74%.

• The proposal referred to companies investing their entire premium in India.

• Implementation required legal/regulatory follow-up.

• The aim was increased capital and participation, not automatic universal insurance.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL FDI ownership limits, prudential solvency, insurance distribution and policyholder protection are different policy dimensions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• More capital can support competition and product development.

• Coverage depends on affordability, claims conduct and distribution; higher FDI alone does not ensure trustworthy protection.

PRELIMS CAUTION An announced 100% limit is not evidence every necessary amendment had already commenced in February.

MAINS PROMPT How can insurance liberalisation improve protection rather than merely expand premium collection?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

Draft foreclosure-charge protections

FEB25-005 · P2 · 2025-02-21 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI consulted on switching costs for floating-rate business loans.

• The draft addressed loans to individuals and micro/small enterprises.

• It proposed no foreclosure/prepayment penalty on specified floating-rate business loans.

• For MSEs, the described aggregate sanctioned limit was ₹7.5 crore per borrower.

• Comments were invited until 21 March; no minimum lock-in was proposed for covered prepayment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Floating-rate loans differ from fixed-rate contracts. Lower exit costs can increase lender competition but do not erase the outstanding principal.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Restrictive exit clauses can prevent borrowers accessing lower rates or better service.

• Final rules need clear scope and disclosures so fees are not simply relabelled elsewhere.

PRELIMS CAUTION This was a draft, not a February universal ban on every charge for every loan. Micro/small is not automatically all medium enterprises.

MAINS PROMPT How can borrower mobility improve credit-market competition?

Sources: [F-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

09 · Logistics & manufacturing

Manufacturing Mission and clean-technology value chains

FEB25-017 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed policy support for small, medium and large industries.

• The mission covered ease/cost of business, workforce, MSMEs, technology and quality.

• Clean-tech priorities included solar cells, batteries, electrolyzers, wind turbines and transmission equipment.

• Domestic value addition and execution/monitoring were emphasised.

• This was a mission proposal, not completed factories.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Assembly, component manufacture and upstream material capability provide different levels of value addition. Clean end-use does not remove upstream environmental costs.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Industrial strategy should address scale, learning, power quality and market demand together.

• For AP, pair clean-energy investment with supplier skills and credible emissions/water accounting.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not equate every listed technology with an individually approved production incentive or a commissioned plant.

MAINS PROMPT What conditions turn clean-technology demand into competitive domestic manufacturing?

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-DETAIL]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

11 · Mineral regulation & critical resources

Barytes, felspar, mica and quartz reclassified

VM2502-003 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reported a move from minor to major-mineral treatment. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The minerals named were barytes, felspar, mica and quartz.

• The rationale includes their association with critical minerals and industrial uses.

• Regulatory classification is different from geological abundance or market value.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Mineral status under the MMDR framework affects regulatory treatment; minor does not simply mean unimportant or low-priced.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP’s barytes resources make reporting, associated-mineral recovery and compliance particularly relevant.

• Policy should connect extraction with processing, environmental management and credible resource information.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not assume all existing leases instantly vanished or that every associated mineral has a commercially recoverable reserve.

MAINS PROMPT How should mineral regulation support critical-resource recovery without weakening environmental oversight?

Sources: [V2502-12], [V-MIN-PIB]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

11 · Transport & infrastructure

Maritime Development Fund and shipbuilding ecosystem

FEB25-016 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed long-term maritime finance and supporting industrial measures.

• The proposed fund corpus was ₹25,000 crore.

• Government contribution was up to 49%, with the balance from ports/private investors.

• Shipbuilding clusters and changes to shipbuilding assistance were proposed.

• Large ships above a specified size were to receive infrastructure-list treatment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A corpus is not necessarily annual expenditure or disbursal. Maritime industrial policy includes vessels, repair, finance, skills and supporting suppliers.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP’s ports and shipbuilding base offer opportunities if financing is linked to credible demand and competitiveness.

• Commercial appraisal, environmental standards and domestic supplier development determine whether public support creates durable value.

PRELIMS CAUTION ₹25,000 crore is not wholly a direct government grant. Announcement is not proof the fund had already financed projects.

MAINS PROMPT How can maritime policy connect trade logistics with domestic manufacturing capability?

Sources: [F-UB], [F-HIGHLIGHTS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

Aircraft Objects Bill and the Cape Town framework

FEB25-009 · P1 · 2025-02-10 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Rajya Sabha introduction addressed rights over high-value aviation assets.

• The Bill sought legal effect for the Cape Town Convention and Aircraft Protocol.

• India had acceded to those agreements in 2008.

• It described creditor remedies after default, DGCA notification and specified asset-detention rights.

• Aircraft, helicopters and engines fall within the relevant asset framework.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Predictable repossession/security rights can affect leasing cost and financing risk. Treaty accession and effective domestic implementation are distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Clear remedies may improve access to aircraft finance and reduce uncertainty.

• The policy must reconcile creditor rights, public-service dues and orderly resolution when an airline fails.

PRELIMS CAUTION This was introduction, not completed enactment. It was not a blanket cancellation of every airline debt or a passenger-compensation law.

MAINS PROMPT Why does legal certainty in asset leasing matter for affordable and reliable aviation?

Sources: [F-PRS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

12 · Housing finance & urban livelihoods

SWAMIH Fund 2: completion finance

FEB25-018 · P2 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed a second blended-finance facility for stalled housing.

• The proposed fund was ₹15,000 crore.

• Contributors were to include government, banks and private investors.

• The target was completion of another one lakh dwelling units.

• The objective addressed households facing both rent and loan instalments on delayed homes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Completion finance is different from a universal home-purchase subsidy or forgiveness of every developer debt. Project selection and cash-flow assessment matter.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Finishing viable stalled projects can unlock sunk investment and relieve households.

• Transparent eligibility, escrow discipline and accountability are needed so rescue does not reward misconduct.

PRELIMS CAUTION A target of one lakh units is not completed February output. Fund size and annual budget release differ.

MAINS PROMPT How should a stressed-housing completion fund protect buyers while limiting moral hazard?

Sources: [F-UB], [F-HIGHLIGHTS]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

PM SVANidhi revamp and first-time entrepreneurs

FEB25-021 · P2 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed expanded small-credit support for underserved urban workers.

• PM SVANidhi revamp included enhanced loans and UPI-linked credit cards with ₹30,000 limits.

• Capacity-building support was proposed for street vendors.

• A separate first-time entrepreneur proposal covered five lakh women/SC/ST entrepreneurs.

• The separate entrepreneur loan ceiling announced was up to ₹2 crore.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Working-capital credit, digital payments and enterprise-development lending have different purposes. Credit access is not proof of profitable self-employment.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Low-friction credit can reduce informal dependence when repayment terms suit volatile incomes.

• Vendor recognition, legal vending space and grievance mechanisms remain important beyond payment digitisation.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not merge the ₹30,000 vendor card with the separate ₹2 crore entrepreneur loan ceiling or describe either as a free grant.

MAINS PROMPT What should inclusive enterprise support provide besides a loan?

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

13 · Energy security

India Energy Week 2025

FEB25-038 · P2 · 2025-02-14 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The third edition combined energy-transition discussions with hydrocarbon investment.

• The event ran 11–14 February at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi.

• The concluding account highlighted exploration licensing and partnerships.

• Biofuels, hydrogen, LNG and renewable technologies featured.

• A conference announcement is not an independently audited delivery outcome.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Energy security balances availability, affordability and sustainability. Expanding a domestic resource does not automatically eliminate import exposure.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• India’s transition must manage growing demand and the reliability of existing supply.

• Evaluate partnerships through realised investment, emissions and technology capability rather than exhibition size or promotional global rankings.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat every displayed technology as commercially deployed or use unverified superlatives as core exam facts.

MAINS PROMPT How should India reconcile near-term energy security with long-term decarbonisation?

Sources: [F-ENERGY]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Agriculture

01 · Productivity & credit

PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana: announcement

CA-004 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget announced a district-focused agriculture programme.

• Budget proposed a state-partnership programme covering 100 districts with low productivity, moderate crop intensity and below-average credit.

• The stated potential reach was 1.7 crore farmers.

• The proposed design uses convergence of existing programmes and partnership with states, not merely a new unconditional transfer.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL District convergence combines complementary interventions; district selection and individual beneficiary eligibility are different.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Local diagnosis should integrate water, credit, extension and markets.

• For AP, targets need district evidence and transparent monitoring rather than assuming every district is covered.

PRELIMS CAUTION Announcement, approval and operational launch have different dates; launch guidelines remain a backfill task.

MAINS PROMPT Design district-specific convergence using credit, irrigation, extension and market access.

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Pulses self-reliance mission

CA-005 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget announced a six-year pulses mission.

• Six-year mission announced with focus on tur, urad and masoor.

• Budget proposed NAFED and NCCF procurement of these pulses over the next four years.

• The four-year procurement commitment is distinct from the six-year mission duration; the announcement is not evidence that all procurement had begun.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Procurement assurance can influence cropping choices, but seed, agronomy and market infrastructure affect the response.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Credible buying arrangements may reduce risk in diversification.

• Water use, local suitability and storage should guide implementation; avoid assuming universal procurement without registration/conditions.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse the mission duration with the procurement commitment period.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss procurement credibility, diversification and water-efficient cropping.

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Kisan Credit Card: proposed subvention ceiling

CA-006 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed a higher subvention-linked KCC loan limit.

• Budget proposed increasing the loan limit under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme from ₹3 lakh to ₹5 lakh for KCC loans.

• The Budget described KCC as facilitating short-term loans to 7.7 crore farmers, fishers and dairy farmers.

• The ₹5 lakh figure concerns the proposed limit under interest subvention; it is not a ₹5 lakh cash grant to every cardholder.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Credit limits and subsidised-interest eligibility are not cash entitlements or proof of loan approval.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Formal credit helps when timely and matched to crop cash flows.

• Tenant farmers, small borrowers and disaster-affected households need usable documentation and repayment support.

PRELIMS CAUTION A credit or subvention limit is not a cash grant; verify operational circulars before treating the change as in force.

MAINS PROMPT How can formal farm credit reduce dependence on informal lenders without worsening indebtedness?

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

02 · Fisheries & blue economy

EEZ and high-seas fisheries framework

CA-007 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed a sustainable EEZ/high-seas fisheries framework.

• Budget proposed a sustainable fisheries framework for India’s EEZ and high seas, with special focus on Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep.

• The stated geographic emphasis included the Andaman and Nicobar and Lakshadweep islands, not only mainland coastal states.

• The announcement concerned a regulatory/enabling framework; it did not itself establish a new universal fisher cash entitlement.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An EEZ gives specified sovereign resource rights; the high seas operate under a different international legal framework.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP marine exports require stock sustainability, traceability, cold chains and crew safety.

• Industrial expansion should not displace small-scale fishers without fair safeguards.

PRELIMS CAUTION EEZ rights and high-seas freedoms are different legal categories.

MAINS PROMPT Connect marine exports with stock conservation, traceability and fisher safety; add AP coastal examples.

Sources: [F-SPEECH]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

05 · High-value crops & institutions

Makhana Board: a Bihar value-chain proposal

FEB25-020 · P2 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed commodity-focused support for makhana producers.

• The Board was proposed for Bihar.

• Functions covered production, processing, value addition and marketing.

• Producers were to be organised into FPOs.

• Training and convergence with existing schemes were emphasised.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A commodity board is a coordination mechanism, not a guaranteed procurement price. Makhana is associated with aquatic cultivation and specialised processing.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Producer aggregation can improve access to technology and bargaining power.

• Success depends on market access, processing quality and ecological sustainability, not institution creation alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Budget proposal is not proof that a functioning board or universal benefits existed that day. Do not confuse this with January’s Turmeric Board launch.

MAINS PROMPT How can a specialised value-chain institution avoid becoming an additional administrative layer?

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-HIGHLIGHTS]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · Price assurance & procurement

PM-AASHA: price support is not universal automatic procurement

VM2502-011 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined continuation and the integrated price-assurance framework. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• PM-AASHA covers mechanisms supporting prices for notified pulses, oilseeds and copra.

• Price Support Scheme procurement involves eligible registered farmers and prescribed quality conditions.

• Procurement operations depend on applicable conditions and state/nodal-agency arrangements.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL MSP announcement, physical procurement and price-deficiency support are different mechanisms.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Price assurance works better with predictable purchase access, payment and storage.

• AP diversification needs attention to tenants, small lots, quality testing and market access rather than assuming an MSP declaration ensures sale at that price.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not apply one crop/year’s procurement ceiling or waiver indiscriminately to every commodity and season.

MAINS PROMPT How can price-assurance programmes support diversification without creating exclusion or unsustainable stocks?

Sources: [V2502-43]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

05 · Soil testing & nutrient management

Soil Health Cards at ten: test quality and farmer use

VM2502-010 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reviewed a programme launched in 2015. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The scheme supports soil testing and nutrient-management recommendations.

• It has been integrated into the Soil Health and Fertility component of the RKVY framework.

• A card must link a representative sample to useful, crop-appropriate advice.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Soil fertility includes chemical, biological and physical properties; a nutrient recommendation is not a guarantee of higher yield.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Laboratory quality, correct sampling and extension determine whether advice changes practice.

• AP nutrient policy should connect testing with balanced input prices, soil organic matter and local crop conditions.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat a card issued as proof that recommendations were followed or that every soil constraint was measured.

MAINS PROMPT Why does soil-testing policy need extension and input-market reform alongside laboratories?

Sources: [V2502-26]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

06 · Seeds, cotton & value chains

Seed mission, gene bank and cotton productivity

FEB25-019 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget linked research capability with climate-resilient farm productivity.

• A High Yielding Seeds Mission was proposed for research and targeted propagation.

• The speech proposed a second gene bank with ten lakh germplasm lines.

• A five-year Cotton Productivity Mission would support sustainability and extra-long staple varieties.

• These were announced objectives, not completed research outputs.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Conserving germplasm, breeding a variety, regulatory assessment and farmer adoption are separate steps. High yield alone does not guarantee local resilience or profitability.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP relevance includes seed systems, cotton quality, water stress and market linkages.

• Public research, seed quality assurance and accessible extension are necessary to turn laboratory potential into reliable farmer benefit.

PRELIMS CAUTION Ten lakh germplasm lines is not ten lakh newly released crop varieties. Cotton and pulses missions have different durations.

MAINS PROMPT How should seed policy balance productivity, genetic diversity and farmer choice?

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-DETAIL]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Society & Welfare

01 · Health & social protection

Gig workers: proposed social-security linkage

CA-010 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed healthcare/social-security linkage for online-platform workers.

• Budget announced identity cards, e-Shram registration and healthcare under PM Jan Arogya Yojana for online-platform gig workers.

• The Budget described the measures as likely to assist nearly one crore gig workers.

• Registration, identity documentation and healthcare linkage are different implementation steps; the announcement does not verify universal enrolment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Registration, eligibility, enrolment and successful access to benefits are distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Portable benefits should accommodate multi-platform work and variable earnings.

• Worker voice, contribution design and usable grievance systems matter beyond identity cards.

PRELIMS CAUTION Registration does not establish that every worker has received all benefits.

MAINS PROMPT Balance platform flexibility with portable benefits, occupational safety and grievance redress.

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Health Budget: seats and service capacity

FEB25-022 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget linked workforce expansion and health-system access.

• Ten thousand additional medical seats were proposed for the next year.

• The five-year ambition was 75,000 additional seats.

• The proposals require institutional and clinical training capacity.

• Separate Budget proposals addressed gig-worker healthcare; that is not the same as seat expansion.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A sanctioned educational seat is not a trained doctor available immediately. Teaching faculty, hospitals, caseload and accreditation determine training quality.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Quantity expansion should address regional imbalance and retention in underserved areas.

• Workforce planning needs nurses, technicians, public-health staff and primary care, not doctors alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not describe all 75,000 seats as added in FY2025–26 or as doctors already graduating in February.

MAINS PROMPT How can medical-education expansion improve service access without compromising quality?

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

01 · Public health

Uganda: Sudan-virus vaccine efficacy trial

FEB25-037 · P1 · 2025-02-03 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS WHO described rapid research mobilisation after the outbreak declaration.

• The trial launched four days after the 30 January outbreak confirmation.

• It tested clinical efficacy of a candidate vaccine against Sudan virus disease.

• Contacts and contacts-of-contacts were organised into rings.

• WHO clarified the wording on 4 February: earlier safety/immunogenicity trials had occurred.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A clinical efficacy trial is not licensing or proof of efficacy. Ebola viruses of different species cannot be assumed to share identical vaccine protection.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Pre-positioned doses and pre-agreed ethical/regulatory procedures can accelerate outbreak research.

• Speed must retain consent, community engagement and reliable endpoint assessment.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call it the first-ever testing of any Ebola vaccine or claim an already licensed Sudan-virus vaccine existed from the trial launch.

MAINS PROMPT How can outbreak preparedness make clinical research both faster and ethically sound?

Sources: [F-EBOLA]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Education & skills

Schools, broadband and AI education

CA-011 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Budget proposed school/PHC connectivity, labs and an AI education centre.

• 50,000 Atal Tinkering Labs proposed in government schools over five years.

• BharatNet broadband proposed for all government secondary schools and PHCs in rural areas.

• AI-for-education Centre of Excellence announced with ₹500 crore outlay.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Connectivity, functional equipment, trained teachers and improved learning are separate outcome stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Digital investments require maintenance, accessible content and teacher support.

• Evaluate inclusion and educational gains rather than count devices alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION These are targets and announcements, not verified completed installations.

MAINS PROMPT Digital access must be paired with teacher capacity, accessible content and learning-outcome measurement.

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Skill India continuation and restructuring

FEB25-006 · P1 · 2025-02-07 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet continued a three-component skills programme.

• The package includes PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana, PM National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme and Jan Shikshan Sansthan.

• The outlay was ₹8,800 crore for FY2022–23 to FY2025–26.

• PMKVY covers short-term/on-job training; apprenticeship support links learners and establishments.

• JSS focuses on accessible vocational training for disadvantaged groups.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Training enrolment, certification, employment and sustained wage gains are different outcome levels. Apprenticeship combines workplace learning with a formal arrangement.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Demand-linked training needs employer participation and credible assessment.

• For AP, monitor placement quality, retention, inclusion and regional access rather than only numbers trained.

PRELIMS CAUTION ₹8,800 crore is a multi-year total, not a fresh annual grant. The three schemes are not interchangeable names.

MAINS PROMPT What indicators would demonstrate that skills spending improves productive employment?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-SKILL]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

02 · Education, language & federalism

Three-language formula: policy flexibility and implementation

VM2502-006 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue addressed state objections and NEP 2020’s approach. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• NEP 2020 provides flexibility in language choice within a three-language approach.

• At least two of the three languages are to be native to India.

• Mother-tongue/home-language teaching recommendations and the three-language formula are related but separate policy elements.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Education is in the Concurrent List; language learning, teaching medium and official-language status are not interchangeable.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Multilingual opportunity requires trained teachers, suitable materials and realistic progression.

• AP implementation should respect learner mobility, local languages and access without assuming a single imposed language follows from the policy.

PRELIMS CAUTION An education policy is not a standalone law mandating Hindi in every state or fixing one medium for every institution.

MAINS PROMPT How can multilingual education balance federal choice with equitable learning opportunities?

Sources: [V2502-30]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

03 · Education evidence & learning

CBSE draft: two Class X examination opportunities

FEB25-007 · P1 · 2025-02-25 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The consultation proposed a second annual opportunity from 2026.

- The draft envisaged examinations in February–March and May.
- Both examinations would use the same syllabus and centres.
- First-exam results could support Class XI admission through DigiLocker.
- Final passing-document arrangements and conditional admissions were described in the draft.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An additional opportunity can change high-stakes assessment incentives. CBSE policy is not automatically every state board’s policy.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

- A second chance may reduce one-shot pressure, but can also increase coaching and administrative load.
- Schools need counselling, scheduling and equitable access so disadvantaged pupils can benefit.

PRELIMS CAUTION The February text was a draft; do not assert final 2026 dates or identical rules for the AP board from it.

MAINS PROMPT How can board-exam reform reduce stress without weakening assessment credibility?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-CBSE]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

03 · Sanitation & public services

SBM-Grameen: sustaining ODF and managing waste

VM2502-007 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed parliamentary scrutiny of rural sanitation. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• SBM-G is a centrally sponsored rural-sanitation programme.

• ODF sustainability extends beyond constructing individual household toilets.

• ODF Plus involves solid/liquid waste management and improved cleanliness alongside sustaining open-defecation-free status.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An infrastructure count, regular use, safe waste handling and health outcomes are different indicators.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Water availability, repairs, inclusion and local maintenance determine whether gains endure.

• Village-level systems need predictable resources and behaviour-sensitive evaluation, not only declaration or award metrics.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not assume a declared ODF village has solved every sanitation or waste-management problem.

MAINS PROMPT Why must rural-sanitation policy move from asset creation to sustained service delivery?

Sources: [V2502-32]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

04 · Preventive health & continuity of care

Intensified NCD screening: diagnosis must lead to care

VM2502-009 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue covered the Health Ministry’s special screening drive. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The drive targeted people aged 30 years and above.

• It included prevalent NCDs and oral, breast and cervical cancer screening.

• Ayushman Arogya Mandirs and other facilities form part of delivery under NP-NCD.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Screening identifies risk or possible disease; confirmatory diagnosis, referral, treatment and follow-up remain necessary.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Coverage can improve early detection only when diagnostics and affordable continuing care are available.

• AP should track referral completion, medicine availability and control of disease, not simply people screened.

PRELIMS CAUTION A screening target is not achieved universal coverage, and a positive screen is not automatically a confirmed diagnosis.

MAINS PROMPT What makes a mass screening programme translate into better health outcomes?

Sources: [V2502-36]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

09 · Data ethics & consumer autonomy

Surveillance capitalism: monetisation of behavioural information

E5-2502-001 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined a critique of data-driven business models. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

• Platforms can infer preferences from observed activity.

• Advertising/personalisation can influence attention and choices.

• Data collection, prediction and decision targeting are different stages.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Consent, fair competition and informational autonomy address different risks; one checkbox does not resolve every power imbalance.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Purpose limitation, meaningful choices and enforceable remedies can reduce exploitative practices.

• Avoid assuming every data use is harmful or every useful service requires unlimited tracking.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-029, E5-2507-021, E5-2508-007, E5-2508-012, E6-2509-011, E6-2509-012, E6-2510-013, E6-2510-014 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat the concept as a statutory offence in itself or repeat unsourced historical digitisation percentages.

MAINS PROMPT How should digital markets preserve autonomy while allowing useful data-driven services?

Sources: [E5-V2502-40]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

10 · Anti-ragging & institutional duty

Ragging prevention: safety, reporting and accountability

E5-2502-002 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed failures in enforcement and institutional culture. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

• Ragging can involve physical, psychological and sexual abuse.

• Hostels and informal hierarchies can create reporting barriers.

• Institutions need prevention, confidential reporting and timely response.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Consent under coercive hierarchy is not automatically free consent; disciplinary and criminal processes serve distinct functions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Protect complainants against retaliation and provide access to support.

• Training and inspection need credible escalation procedures rather than ceremonial anti-ragging declarations.

READ ACROSS MONTHS · NOTE IDS E5-2507-034, E7-2512-029, E7-2512-032, E8-2601-011, E8-2601-012, E8-2601-037, E9-2602-038, E10-2603-043 · Full sequences: Cross-Month Reading Journeys.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not normalise humiliating abuse as harmless tradition or assume absence of complaints proves a safe campus.

MAINS PROMPT How can educational institutions make anti-ragging duties operational?

Sources: [E5-V2502-41]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

Environment

02 · Wetlands

World Wetlands Day at Parvati Arga

FEB25-031 · P2 · 2025-02-02 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The national event highlighted management as well as recognition.

• The venue was Parvati Arga Ramsar Site in Gonda, Uttar Pradesh.

• The theme was Protecting Wetlands for our Common Future.

• An integrated management plan was among the publications launched.

• Tourism-corridor intentions were announced separately.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL 2 February commemorates adoption of the Ramsar Convention. A management plan, site designation and wetland-city accreditation are different processes.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Integrated management needs hydrology, catchment pollution control and compatible livelihoods.

• For AP, apply this lens to wetland pressures rather than simply adding another site-name flashcard.

PRELIMS CAUTION A publication titled Factbook of India’s 85 Ramsar Sites is not proof the February national total remained 85. Publication scope and current count differ.

MAINS PROMPT Why should wetland policy be evaluated through ecological condition rather than designation counts alone?

Sources: [F-WETLAND]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Water & urban sustainability

Jal Jeevan Mission and urban financing

CA-012 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Budget proposed extending water coverage and new urban finance.

• Budget proposed extending Jal Jeevan Mission until 2028.

• Urban Challenge Fund announced at ₹1 lakh crore, with ₹10,000 crore proposed for 2025–26.

• The Urban Challenge Fund was to support part of bankable urban project costs, not replace all project financing.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A multi-year corpus, annual allocation, sanction and release differ. A tap connection is not proof of continuous safe supply.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Water services need source protection, quality testing and affordable O&M.

• Urban projects need credible finance and local capacity; announced funds are not automatic municipal revenue.

PRELIMS CAUTION A multi-year fund corpus differs from the annual allocation and actual releases.

MAINS PROMPT Examine water-service sustainability through source protection, O&M and local fiscal capacity.

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

07 · Global biodiversity governance

Resumed CBD COP16: Rome finance agreement and Cali Fund

FEB25-030 · P1 · 2025-02-27 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The resumed session addressed business unfinished in Cali in 2024.

• The resumed talks were held in Rome on 25–27 February.

• Parties agreed a resource-mobilisation strategy linked to at least US$200 billion annually by 2030.

• Monitoring, reporting and review arrangements were among the outcomes.

• The Cali Fund for benefit-sharing from digital sequence information was launched; its establishment had been agreed earlier.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL CBD COP16 is not UNFCCC COP16. Digital sequence information concerns genetic-resource information; benefit sharing differs from physical access permission.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Finance strategies need actual contributions and transparent delivery to close implementation gaps.

• The Fund connects biotechnology value creation with biodiversity stewardship and Indigenous/local-community interests.

PRELIMS CAUTION US$200 billion is a mobilisation goal, not cash already collected in Rome. Do not misdate the earlier decision establishing the Cali Fund.

MAINS PROMPT What would make biodiversity finance both adequate and equitable?

Sources: [F-CBD], [F-CBD2]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Science & Technology

01 · Space

CE20 vacuum-ignition trial

FEB25-033 · P1 · 2025-02-07 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS ISRO tested a multi-element igniter in simulated space-vacuum conditions.

• The test was at IPRC Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu.

• CE20 powers LVM3’s cryogenic upper stage.

• The trial formed part of work toward restart capability.

• ISRO described further testing, including bootstrap-start studies.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Cryogenic propulsion uses very low-temperature propellants. A ground vacuum-ignition trial differs from demonstrated repeated in-flight restart.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Restart capability can enable more flexible orbital operations when qualified across the full mission envelope.

• Reliable ignition, thermal behaviour and propellant management require staged validation.

PRELIMS CAUTION This was not a new satellite launch or proof that all flight-restart tests were complete. The test was 7 February; the web announcement was 8 February.

MAINS PROMPT Why do propulsion programmes use ground simulations before flight demonstration?

Sources: [F-CE20]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Asteroid 2024 YR4: risk sharply downgraded

FEB25-036 · P1 · 2025-02-24 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS More observations narrowed orbit uncertainty after earlier public concern.

• NASA’s 24 February update placed Earth-impact probability for December 2032 at 0.004%.

• It described no significant Earth threat over the next century on that evidence.

• Further observations had refined the predicted trajectory.

• The agency separately discussed a small lunar-impact probability, not an Earth impact.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Impact probability changes as an uncertain orbit is constrained. A temporarily rising probability can reflect changing uncertainty, not an asteroid deliberately changing course.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The episode tests observation networks, international notification and risk communication.

• Communicate both probability and uncertainty rather than repeat the month’s most alarming headline after it has been superseded.

PRELIMS CAUTION The 0.004% is a dated estimate, not a permanent current lunar or Earth probability. Avoid confusing the two targets.

MAINS PROMPT How should agencies communicate a low-probability high-consequence risk as evidence changes?

Sources: [F-ASTEROID]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Energy technology

Nuclear Energy Mission and SMRs

CA-009 · P1 · 2025-02-01 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed an SMR research mission and nuclear-law changes.

• Budget announced ₹20,000 crore for research and development of small modular reactors.

• The stated goal was at least five indigenously developed SMRs operational by 2033.

• Amendments to nuclear-energy and liability legislation were proposed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL SMRs are reactor designs with modular/smaller-unit characteristics, not automatically risk-free or commercially mature.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Evaluate licensing, waste, liability, fuel and cost alongside decarbonisation potential.

• A research allocation and a 2033 target do not establish deployed generation in February.

PRELIMS CAUTION A 2033 target is not an achieved capacity figure; a proposed amendment is not an enacted law.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss nuclear expansion through safety, liability, finance, fuel security and decarbonisation.

Sources: [F-UB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

05 · Ocean technology & safety

Matsya 6000: testing is not a completed deep dive

VM2502-008 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reported wet testing of the indigenous submersible programme. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Matsya 6000 is being developed under Samudrayaan within the Deep Ocean Mission.

• The design objective is a three-person vehicle capable of reaching 6,000 metres.

• NIOT, Chennai, under the Ministry of Earth Sciences is the development institution.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Pressure qualification, wet tests, crew safety and a demonstrated operational deep dive are distinct validation stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Ocean technology can support biodiversity research and resource assessment while requiring rigorous environmental safeguards.

• Qualification must test life support, communications, recovery and emergency contingencies, not only nominal depth design.

PRELIMS CAUTION A wet test does not prove that people already reached 6,000 metres in the vehicle.

MAINS PROMPT How should deep-sea exploration combine technological ambition with human and ecological safety?

Sources: [V2502-35]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

07 · Scientific administration

National Science Day: Raman effect and research culture

FEB25-050 · P3 · 2025-02-28 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The annual observance highlighted youth leadership in science and innovation.

• The 2025 theme concerned empowering Indian youth for global science/innovation leadership for Viksit Bharat.

• 28 February commemorates discovery of the Raman effect.

• C.V. Raman received the Nobel Prize in Physics in 1930.

• The first National Science Day observance was in 1987.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Raman scattering is inelastic scattering of light, involving an energy/frequency change. It differs from elastic Rayleigh scattering.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• An anniversary is a useful entry point to spectroscopy and scientific temper.

• Research opportunity needs laboratories, mentorship, merit-based access and stable support beyond ceremonial events.

PRELIMS CAUTION Discovery year, Nobel year and start of the annual observance are distinct. A theme is not proof of achieved global leadership.

MAINS PROMPT What institutional conditions help young researchers contribute to public-interest innovation?

Sources: [F-SCIENCEDAY]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

08 · AI governance

EU AI Act: first requirements apply

FEB25-032 · P1 · 2025-02-02 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Selected prohibitions and literacy duties began before the wider framework’s later phases.

• Prohibited-practice provisions and AI-literacy obligations applied from 2 February.

• The framework follows a risk-based approach.

• Covered practices include specified manipulation, social scoring and certain biometric/emotion-recognition uses, with legal qualifications.

• Other provisions had different implementation dates.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Entry into force and phased application are distinct. Risk categories and prohibited practices should be studied from the operative legal text, not simplified slogans.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AI literacy is an organisational governance requirement, not merely teaching users to write prompts.

• India can draw comparative lessons while choosing a context-appropriate mix of safeguards and innovation support.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not claim the entire EU AI Act first became law on 2 February. The Commission’s live page includes later changes that must not be projected backward.

MAINS PROMPT What are the strengths and limitations of risk-based AI regulation?

Sources: [F-EUAI], [F-EUAI2]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Astronomy & fundamental science

Euclid reveals an Einstein ring

FEB25-034 · P2 · 2025-02-10 (reporting date) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS ESA published the gravitational-lensing discovery around NGC6505.

• NGC6505 is the foreground lens galaxy, about 590 million light-years away.

• Its mass bends and magnifies light from a more distant background galaxy.

• Near alignment creates the ring appearance.

• The February milestone was publication/announcement, not necessarily the original observation date.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Gravitational lensing follows the curvature of spacetime. It is not an ordinary ring of material physically orbiting the foreground galaxy.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Lensing can probe mass distributions and distant objects, including matter not directly luminous.

• Geometry and modelling matter; a striking image is not by itself a complete dark-matter explanation.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not identify the ring as a planetary ring or claim the galaxy was first discovered in 2025.

MAINS PROMPT How can gravitational lensing act as both a natural telescope and a tool for studying mass?

Sources: [F-EUCLID]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

KM3NeT’s ultra-high-energy neutrino announcement

FEB25-035 · P2 · 2025-02-12 (reporting date) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The collaboration reported an event with an estimated neutrino energy around 220 PeV.

• The result used an underwater Mediterranean detector.

• A muon crossing the detector supplied the signal used to infer the neutrino event.

• The February announcement followed analysis of an earlier detected event.

• The team described it as the highest-energy neutrino observed at that time.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Neutrinos interact weakly; detectors infer them from secondary signals. A petaelectronvolt is an energy unit, not a distance or luminosity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Extreme-energy neutrinos can open a window onto violent cosmic processes.

• One event’s interpretation involves substantial uncertainty; energy estimates and source attribution are different questions.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not say the event was physically detected for the first time on its publication date or that its source was conclusively located.

MAINS PROMPT Why do weakly interacting particles offer information unavailable from ordinary light alone?

Sources: [F-NEUTRINO]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Security

01 · Defence & strategy

Aero India 2025: industrial partnerships

FEB25-039 · P2 · 2025-02-10 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The fifteenth edition took place at Yelahanka, Bengaluru.

• The dates were 10–14 February.

• The theme was The Runway to a Billion Opportunities.

• Business and public days were distinguished.

• The exhibition included foreign aircraft and domestic-industry participation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An air-show appearance, a memorandum, a procurement decision and an inducted operational platform are different stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Aerospace capability requires engines, components, certification, maintenance and supplier learning.

• Assess partnerships by technology depth and sustainable production rather than the number of display aircraft.

PRELIMS CAUTION F-35 or Su-57 participation at an exhibition does not establish an Indian purchase contract.

MAINS PROMPT How can defence exhibitions support capability rather than remain announcement-driven events?

Sources: [F-AERO]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Military exercises

TROPEX-25: operational update

FEB25-040 · P1 · 2025-02-07 (reporting date) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Navy reported its capstone biennial readiness exercise underway.

- The exercise spanned January–March 2025 in the Indian Ocean Region.
- It integrated naval units with Army, Air Force and Coast Guard assets.
- Phases included harbour/sea activity, cyber/electronic warfare and amphibious operations.
- The release described approximately 65 ships, nine submarines and over 80 aircraft.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Jointness means coordinated operations across services; interoperability includes communications, procedures and logistics. A domestic exercise differs from a bilateral drill.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

- Realistic scenarios can reveal gaps in sustainment and coordinated response.
- Readiness should be assessed through validated lessons and corrective action, not platform counts alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION 7 February is the reporting date, not the exercise’s entire duration. TROPEX was not a one-day India–US exercise.

MAINS PROMPT What makes a joint exercise useful for operational readiness?

Sources: [F-TROPEX]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Information, cyber & critical infrastructure

Hybrid threats: resilience across institutional boundaries

VM2502-012 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue highlighted convergence between conventional and non-kinetic threats. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Hybrid strategies can combine military, cyber, economic and information instruments.

• Critical infrastructure can be targeted without a formally declared war.

• Domestic and cross-border responsibilities can overlap during such incidents.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Hybrid warfare and asymmetric warfare overlap but are not exact synonyms; every protest, cyber incident or critical opinion is not warfare.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Preparedness needs continuity planning, trusted communication, cyber hygiene and clear civil-military roles.

• Protecting security must preserve evidentiary standards and civil liberties rather than attributing all social disagreement to foreign actors.

PRELIMS CAUTION A broad security label does not establish attribution or justify unrestricted surveillance.

MAINS PROMPT How can societies build resilience to hybrid threats without securitising legitimate democratic activity?

Sources: [V2502-22]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

06 · Mass-gathering safety

SLBC tunnel collapse: construction and rescue risk

FEB25-048 · P1 · 2025-02-22 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A tunnel section collapsed near Domalapenta in Telangana.

• The incident was on 22 February in Nagarkurnool district.

• Eight workers were reported trapped in contemporary accounts.

• Rescue involved multiple technical and emergency agencies.

• February reports do not establish the eventual outcome for every missing person.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Srisailam Left Bank Canal tunnel is not the Polavaram project. Underground safety depends on geology, water ingress, support systems and worker access.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Prevention requires updated geotechnical assessment, instrumentation and enforceable safety protocols.

• Rescue requires specialist coordination, air/water management and protection of rescuers against secondary failure.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not relocate the incident to AP merely because Srisailam is linked to an interstate river project. Final casualty outcomes need later sources.

MAINS PROMPT What should a major underground-project safety and rescue framework contain?

Sources: [F-SLBC]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

International Relations

03 · Indo-Pacific & bilateral relations

France visit and the AI declaration

FEB25-011 · P1 · 2025-02-12 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS India and France linked AI cooperation with privacy, diversity and scientific collaboration.

• The countries signed an AI declaration on 12 February.

• PRS records principles of global benefit, human rights/privacy and linguistic/cultural diversity.

• Intent included an Indo-French Centre of Digital Sciences and work on advanced/SMR technology.

• Defence R&D cooperation was also discussed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL AI governance includes access, safety, data, compute and market structure. A bilateral declaration is not a binding global AI treaty.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Public-interest AI requires affordable compute and meaningful participation by under-represented languages.

• Research collaboration should be assessed by interoperable standards and shared capability, not diplomatic vocabulary alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat intent on reactors or research centres as proof of completed facilities. France’s bilateral declaration differs from the wider summit outcome.

MAINS PROMPT How can international AI cooperation balance innovation, inclusion and rights?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-FRANCE]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

04 · India–US & technology diplomacy

India–US talks: trade, defence and technology intent

FEB25-010 · P1 · 2025-02-13 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The joint statement outlined a programme for deeper bilateral cooperation.

• The two sides targeted bilateral trade of US$500 billion by 2030.

• They sought a first tranche of a bilateral trade agreement in 2025.

• A new ten-year defence framework and expanded technology cooperation were envisaged.

• Energy trade and possible localised US-designed nuclear-reactor cooperation were discussed.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A joint statement expresses agreed intent; procurement, treaty commitments, commercial contracts and operational projects require distinct follow-up.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• India can pursue market access and technology while diversifying strategic options.

• Evaluate local capability, commercial viability and regulatory conditions rather than assume promised trade is already achieved.

PRELIMS CAUTION The US$500 billion figure is a target, not February realised trade. A procurement discussion is not a signed purchase contract.

MAINS PROMPT What makes a strategic partnership translate into durable domestic capability?

Sources: [F-PRS], [F-US]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

04 · Trade, technology & strategic risk

Geo-economic fragmentation: diversification versus decoupling

VM2502-004 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue used the Economic Survey to examine strategically driven economic barriers. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Fragmentation can affect trade, investment, payments and technology diffusion.

• Friendshoring favours politically aligned partners; nearshoring prioritises geographic proximity.

• Selective supply-chain relocation is not proof that all global integration has ended.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Concentration risk, resilience, efficiency and comparative advantage are related but distinct policy considerations.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Diversification can reduce a single-point dependency while raising costs or creating new common exposures.

• AP export sectors need market and input-risk mapping rather than assuming every relocation opportunity will become a local investment.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not equate a policy-driven trend with the complete replacement of globalisation.

MAINS PROMPT How can economic resilience be improved without indiscriminate self-isolation?

Sources: [V2502-04]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

05 · Development cooperation

Triangular cooperation: roles matter more than the number three

VM2502-005 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-02 · web posted: 2025-03-24 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reviewed OECD/Islamic Development Bank discussion of development partnerships. This is a 2025-02 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Triangular cooperation combines complementary resources and expertise among development partners.

• A facilitating partner can support cooperation between a pivotal partner and a beneficiary partner.

• Its purpose is development co-creation, not necessarily military or diplomatic alignment.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Triangular cooperation is distinct from any generic three-country agreement or a strategic triangle.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Partner-led priorities, shared learning and local institutional capacity can improve delivery.

• Evaluate accountability and transaction costs so additional partners do not simply multiply coordination burdens.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not call every three-party MoU triangular development cooperation or treat historical project proposals as completed projects.

MAINS PROMPT When can triangular development cooperation outperform a conventional donor-recipient model?

Sources: [V2502-06]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

08 · Trade negotiations

India–UK FTA negotiations resume

FEB25-012 · P1 · 2025-02-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The two governments restarted negotiations after a pause.

• Piyush Goyal and Jonathan Reynolds announced resumption.

• The aim was a balanced, mutually beneficial agreement.

• Goods, services and investment issues were among the negotiating concerns.

• Parallel investment/social-contribution discussions were reported separately.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Negotiation, political conclusion, signature, ratification and entry into force are different trade-agreement stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Potential gains depend on actual tariff schedules, rules of origin and services access.

• AP exporters need product-level opportunities and standards capacity rather than a generic assumption that every export becomes duty-free.

PRELIMS CAUTION The February restart is not the date a final FTA entered into force. Later milestones must be indexed separately.

MAINS PROMPT How should India evaluate a trade agreement beyond the number of tariff lines liberalised?

Sources: [F-UK]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Political transitions & Europe

Germany votes: coalition formation still ahead

FEB25-052 · P2 · 2025-02-23 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The election made the CDU/CSU bloc the largest grouping.

• Provisional contemporary reporting placed CDU/CSU first and AfD second.

• Friedrich Merz led the CDU campaign.

• The election was on 23 February.

• A parliamentary election result precedes coalition agreement and formal election of a chancellor.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Germany’s Bundestag elects the chancellor within its constitutional framework. Winning the largest vote share does not equal an immediate direct popular mandate to take office.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Coalition politics and economic/security priorities matter for India–Europe relations.

• Use official final results for exact percentages; provisional rounded figures can differ from final accounts.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not label Merz an already sworn-in chancellor on election night. Do not equate vote share with seat share.

MAINS PROMPT Why is government formation a separate analytical stage after a parliamentary election?

Sources: [F-GERMANY]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Andhra Pradesh

01 · State economy & budget

AP Budget 2025–26: fiscal snapshot

CA-016 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS AP’s Finance Minister presented the state Budget on 28 February.

• Total expenditure including debt repayment: ₹3,22,359 crore.

• Net expenditure excluding debt repayment: ₹2,97,929 crore.

• Fiscal deficit BE: ₹79,927 crore, about 4.4% of GSDP; revenue deficit BE: ₹33,186 crore, about 1.8%.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Gross expenditure includes debt repayment; net expenditure excludes it. Ratios use the relevant nominal GSDP denominator.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Compare BE, RE and actuals consistently when discussing fiscal consolidation.

• Borrowing for productive assets differs economically from financing persistent revenue gaps.

PRELIMS CAUTION PRS rounds amounts; news reports may use less-rounded figures. Never mix gross and net expenditure.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate AP’s fiscal space through revenue mobilisation, committed expenditure and capital-asset quality.

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

AP GSDP: nominal projection versus real growth

CA-017 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget projected nominal GSDP for FY2025–26.

• AP’s 2025–26 current-price GSDP projected at about ₹18.3 lakh crore.

• The projected 14% increase is over the 2024–25 revised estimate.

• The figure is a current-price state aggregate; price changes are included, unlike in a constant-price real-growth estimate.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Current-price growth includes price changes; constant-price growth seeks to remove them. Per-capita GSDP is not household disposable income.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Diversification and productivity matter alongside aggregate growth.

• Avoid using a higher state average as proof that every district or household is better off.

PRELIMS CAUTION Current-price growth is not real economic growth.

MAINS PROMPT Use sectoral diversification, productivity and resilient coastal livelihoods to assess growth quality.

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

AP receipts and the BE–RE credibility gap

FEB25-044 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget analysis showed why a larger planned outlay needs a credible revenue base.

• FY2025–26 non-borrowing receipts were estimated at ₹2,18,002 crore, 24% above FY2024–25 RE.

• FY2024–25 non-borrowing receipts were revised 12% below BE.

• The FY2024–25 revenue deficit was revised to 3.0% of GSDP, versus 2.1% BE.

• Net expenditure was also revised lower, yet the deficit ratio rose.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Budget Estimates are plans; Revised Estimates update expectations; Actuals record realised outcomes. Deficit is affected by both revenue and spending.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Under-realised revenue can widen deficits despite spending compression.

• AP should stress-test assumptions, improve collection and protect high-value services from abrupt cash rationing.

PRELIMS CAUTION A 24% projected receipts increase is not realised growth or proof of a comparable real economic expansion.

MAINS PROMPT How can a state strengthen fiscal credibility when receipts repeatedly undershoot targets?

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

Central capex loans and AP borrowing

FEB25-045 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS PRS separated special long-term Union loans from other borrowing.

• AP budgeted ₹10,200 crore of central capex loans for FY2025–26.

• FY2024–25 RE for these loans was ₹11,750 crore.

• PRS describes the Union’s 50-year interest-free capital-expenditure loan arrangement.

• It notes their exclusion from the state borrowing-ceiling calculation under that arrangement.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Interest-free is not repayment-free. Fiscal-deficit accounting, debt stocks and an administratively permitted borrowing ceiling are separate concepts.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Long-tenor finance can support productive assets if appraisal and execution are strong.

• AP must budget maintenance and contingent obligations so cheaper finance does not substitute for project quality.

PRELIMS CAUTION Exclusion from a borrowing-ceiling calculation does not mean the loan vanishes from all debt/fiscal analysis.

MAINS PROMPT How should states assess concessional borrowing for infrastructure?

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

02 · Welfare & human development

Talliki Vandanam: budget proposal

CA-018 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS AP’s Budget proposed education-linked support for FY2025–26.

• AP Budget proposed ₹15,000 annually for each school-going child in Classes I–XII from 2025–26.

• Budget policy description included both government and private schools.

• The announced benefit was framed per school-going child; eligibility and actual payment require subsequent implementation records.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A budget policy description is distinct from beneficiary GOs, payment conditions and actual disbursal.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Assess attendance, retention and learning as well as financial coverage.

• Reliable eligibility and appeals help avoid excluding vulnerable children.

PRELIMS CAUTION Budget policy intent is not a substitute for beneficiary eligibility GOs, deductions or payment records.

MAINS PROMPT Assess enrolment incentives alongside attendance, learning outcomes and fiscal sustainability.

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

03 · Coastal livelihoods

Fishing-ban relief: budget commitment

CA-019 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed doubling fishing-ban relief.

• AP Budget proposed increasing fishing-ban financial relief from ₹10,000 to ₹20,000.

• The proposal doubles the stated relief amount; it is not a change to the biological conservation rationale for a seasonal ban.

• The February Budget commitment precedes the April launch reporting; the two milestones must not be treated as simultaneous.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Closed-season compensation can protect income while supporting stock recovery.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Timely, accessible support improves compliance incentives.

• Check beneficiary definitions, coverage, payment timing and ecological evidence rather than assume all fisher households received it.

PRELIMS CAUTION A budget commitment does not prove disbursal to every eligible fisher.

MAINS PROMPT How can closed-season compensation align livelihood protection with marine stock recovery?

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

04 · Innovation & infrastructure

Amaravati innovation hub: proposal

CA-020 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed a hub-and-zonal-centre innovation network.

• Budget proposed an Amaravati innovation hub linked with five zonal centres.

• Mentoring, emerging-sector skills and technology upgrading were stated functions.

• The design envisaged a hub-and-zonal-centre network; a Budget proposal is not confirmation that every centre was operating.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An innovation ecosystem needs institutions, finance, mentors, skills and market access, not just a building.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP should connect district universities and MSMEs to opportunity.

• Measure viable firms, technology adoption and jobs rather than only event attendance or MoUs.

PRELIMS CAUTION Proposed infrastructure should not be described as operational without follow-up evidence.

MAINS PROMPT Propose a decentralised start-up ecosystem linking universities, districts and local industry.

Sources: [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web analysis read; additional Budget-speech claims use inspected source extracts

Amaravati and Polavaram: budgeted capital priorities

FEB25-046 · P1 · 2025-02-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget made provisions for two major state development priorities.

• The Hindu reported ₹6,000 crore for Amaravati.

• It reported ₹6,705 crore for Polavaram.

• These are FY2025–26 budget provisions, not February expenditure certificates.

• The projects have distinct financing, clearance and execution structures.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A budget allocation, funding agreement, loan drawdown, work award and certified physical progress are different milestones.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Capital-city works need climate-resilient planning, service delivery and transparent procurement.

• Irrigation development also needs safety, rehabilitation and environmental compliance.

• Compare physical milestones and outcomes with spending rather than use allocation size as the only success measure.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not add previously announced external financing to an annual provision as though both were new cash expenditure in February.

MAINS PROMPT How can AP reconcile accelerated infrastructure delivery with fiscal and social safeguards?

Sources: [F-APNEWS]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · Inclusive industry & administration

AP Cabinet: targeted enterprise incentives

FEB25-041 · P1 · 2025-02-06 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Cabinet approved policy amendments for specified under-represented entrepreneurs.

• Reporting described investment subsidy rising from 35% to 45% for the identified categories.

• Land-support changes for SC/ST entrepreneurs and power-incentive changes were also reported.

• The package covered amendments to multiple sectoral policies.

• Transport/logistics support and GST reimbursement were among the decisions described.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Cabinet approval, operative GO, eligibility determination and reimbursement are distinct. Percentages often have caps and conditions that cannot be omitted in an application.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Targeted support can address unequal access to capital and business networks.

• Evaluate additional viable enterprises, survival, payment delays and inclusion—not just sanctioned subsidy amounts.

PRELIMS CAUTION This note is not a complete eligibility guide; verify the applicable GO, category, cap, duration and investment base before using a percentage.

MAINS PROMPT How can AP design targeted enterprise incentives that expand opportunity without creating rent-seeking?

Sources: [F-APCAB]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Irrigation & disaster resilience

Polavaram rehabilitation: fresh-tender decision

FEB25-047 · P1 · 2025-02-06 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Cabinet’s February account included unfinished rehabilitation-colony works.

• Fresh tenders were to be invited for remaining R&R housing-colony works.

• Basic amenities as well as houses were included in the reported commitment.

• The decision was part of the 6 February Cabinet meeting.

• It did not certify that every affected family had been rehabilitated.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Resettlement moves people; rehabilitation restores livelihoods and social functioning. A completed house alone does not establish adequate rehabilitation.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Independent verification should cover land/entitlements, water, schools, health, transport and livelihood access.

• Participation and usable grievance channels are essential when displacement is involuntary.

PRELIMS CAUTION Approval to tender is not completed construction or proof of consent/settlement of all claims.

MAINS PROMPT What should an outcome-based rehabilitation audit of a large irrigation project examine?

Sources: [F-APCAB]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

11 · One Health & agricultural livelihoods

Poultry H5N1 confirmation and One Health

FEB25-042 · P1 · 2025-02-11 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS February reports moved from suspected poultry mortality to laboratory-confirmed avian influenza.

• The report concerned Kanuru/Peravali in East Godavari.

• Samples were sent to specialised laboratories including NIHSAD, Bhopal.

• Authorities described culling zones, rapid-response teams and carcass-disposal precautions.

• Poultry cases do not establish confirmed human cases.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL One Health connects animal, human and environmental health. Suspicion, laboratory confirmation and demonstrated transmission pathway are different evidence stages.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Biosecurity, veterinary surveillance, safe disposal, worker protection and fair compensation should operate together.

• Communication must distinguish official current food-safety advice from broad alarming newspaper headlines; do not improvise dietary guidance from this note.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not assert migratory birds caused the outbreak without evidence, confuse H5N1 with Newcastle disease, or treat all poultry deaths as individually confirmed.

MAINS PROMPT How should AP coordinate veterinary, public-health and livelihood responses to an animal-disease outbreak?

Sources: [F-APFLU]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

12 · Legislature & budget accountability

AP legislature’s Budget Session

FEB25-043 · P2 · 2025-02-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The session calendar linked the Governor’s address with the state budget.

• The preview placed the session opening on 24 February.

• Governor S. Abdul Nazeer was to address the Assembly and Council.

• The Budget was subsequently presented on 28 February.

• Political participation and any final sitting schedule require the official proceedings for confirmation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Article 176 concerns a Governor’s special address. Legislative absence and disqualification require the precise constitutional conditions, not an oversimplified count of calendar days.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Attendance matters because scrutiny of spending and executive claims is a representative responsibility.

• Study the role of the Business Advisory Committee and committee/demand scrutiny alongside floor debate.

PRELIMS CAUTION The opening detail relies on a pre-event report; it is labelled accordingly. Do not treat a preview’s likely sitting count as a verified final total.

MAINS PROMPT What would improve substantive budget scrutiny in a state legislature?

Sources: [F-APSESSION], [F-APB]

Evidence access: Full PRS web synthesis read; linked primary texts not necessarily independently read

Culture & History

03 · Manuscripts & knowledge heritage

Gyan Bharatam Mission proposed

FEB25-014 · P2 · 2025-02-01 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Budget proposed a large manuscript-survey and conservation effort.

• The stated coverage ambition was more than one crore manuscripts.

• Academic institutions, museums, libraries and private collectors were identified as partners.

• Survey, documentation and conservation were core tasks.

• The speech also envisaged wider digital access to knowledge heritage.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Cataloguing, physical conservation, digitisation, transcription and translation are distinct stages. A digital image is not necessarily searchable or understood text.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Preservation requires suitable storage and trained conservators alongside scanning.

• Access should respect provenance, linguistic diversity and legitimate community/owner interests.

PRELIMS CAUTION One crore is a proposed coverage target, not manuscripts already conserved in February. A new mission does not erase earlier manuscript initiatives.

MAINS PROMPT What would a credible national manuscript-preservation strategy require beyond digitisation?

Sources: [F-SPEECH], [F-DETAIL]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Communities & performing traditions

Jhumoir Binandini and Assam’s tea communities

FEB25-051 · P3 · 2025-02-24 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Guwahati event foregrounded a living performing tradition.

• The programme took place on 24 February.

• Jhumoir was described as a folk dance of Assam’s Tea Tribe and Adivasi communities.

• PIB described around 8,000 performers.

• The event was linked to commemoration of 200 years of the tea industry in Assam.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Living heritage belongs to communities and includes language, practice and social context; a large stage event is only one expression.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Cultural recognition should be connected to community dignity, education and livelihoods.

• Avoid assuming that visibility at a national event settles longstanding socio-economic disadvantage.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse Jhumoir with Bihu or claim this event itself granted UNESCO inscription.

MAINS PROMPT How can cultural promotion support the communities sustaining the tradition?

Sources: [F-JHUMOIR]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Awards & Sports

03 · Competitions

National Games conclude: Services lead the gold tally

FEB25-049 · P3 · 2025-02-14 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The event that opened in January produced its final results in February.

• Services Sports Control Board led with 68 gold medals.

• Its reported total was 121 medals.

• Maharashtra had a larger overall medal count but fewer golds.

• The host was Uttarakhand and the closing date 14 February.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Medal-table ordering commonly prioritises gold, then silver and bronze, not simply total medals.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• The opening and the results are separate monthly milestones, not duplicate descriptions of the same development.

• Use results for concise factual recall; evaluate broader sporting policy through participation and athlete pathways.

PRELIMS CAUTION The team with most total medals need not top the gold-ordered table. Do not put February results into January’s as-of record.

MAINS PROMPT Explain how medal-table order can differ from total-medal order.

Sources: [F-GAMES]

Evidence access: Supporting source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

February 2025 recall laboratory

30 original questions, not previous-year questions. Answers follow all questions. Historical monthly snapshot only.

1. What did the February 2025 MPC decide?

A. Cut repo to 6.25% and retain neutral stance

B. Cut repo to 6% and adopt accommodative stance

C. Abolish the repo corridor

D. Raise repo to 6.75%

2. The February GDP release’s FY2024–25 real growth estimate of 6.5% was a:

A. Final census finding

B. Second advance estimate

C. Monthly industrial-production rate

D. Nominal AP GSDP forecast

3. The Income-Tax Bill’s February milestone was:

A. Repeal of all indirect taxes

B. Universal commencement

C. Approval by the GST Council

D. Introduction in Lok Sabha

4. NAKSHA is most directly associated with:

A. Urban land-record surveying

B. Crop insurance premium payment

C. Deep-sea mining licences

D. Lunar navigation

5. Which is the safest interpretation of the February insurance FDI announcement?

A. Foreign ownership was banned

B. 100% was proposed with specified conditions

C. It applied only to public-sector banks

D. Every condition was abolished immediately

6. Why can Budget capex allocations not be reported as completed development?

A. Budgets are confidential

B. Allocation, release, expenditure and outcome are distinct stages

C. Capex never creates assets

D. All capital projects are centrally owned

7. Which geography is correctly matched?

A. Makhana Board proposal—Bihar

B. Aero India—Chennai

C. Parvati Arga—Kerala

D. SLBC collapse—Andhra Pradesh

8. SWAMIH Fund 2 was proposed principally to:

A. Construct only rural roads

B. Finance completion of stressed housing projects

C. Replace municipal property taxation

D. Subsidise all new luxury homes

9. In the Maritime Development Fund proposal, the government contribution was to be:

A. 100%

B. Exactly zero

C. At least 90%

D. Up to 49%

10. Gyan Bharatam primarily addresses:

A. Fisheries monitoring

B. Retail bank accounts

C. Manuscript survey, documentation and conservation

D. Satellite launches

11. The CBSE February two-examination framework should be described as:

A. A compulsory third Class XII exam already conducted

B. A draft Class X policy for consultation

C. A UGC postgraduate reform

D. Repeal of board examinations

12. Why is the AP GSDP projection not interchangeable with real national GDP growth?

A. State figures cannot be estimated

B. It measures only agriculture

C. It was nominal and state-specific

D. Nominal growth excludes prices

13. The new-regime income-tax rebate headline should not be interpreted as:

A. Different from the standard deduction

B. A conditional benefit under the new regime

C. A universal zero-tax rule for every kind of income under every regime

D. Subject to applicable income and tax rules

14. Manipur’s February President’s Rule is associated principally with:

A. Article 280

B. Article 356

C. Article 110

D. Article 21

15. What was the February status of the Tamil Nadu Governor’s Bills case?

A. Judgment reserved, not the later April ruling

B. The issue transferred to RBI

C. A constitutional amendment enacted

D. Final April ruling already delivered

16. The Supreme Court’s February action on Lokpal jurisdiction over HC judges was a:

A. New constitutional amendment

B. Transfer of judges to the executive

C. Final abolition of the Lokpal

D. Stay of the impugned order pending examination

17. The Rome CBD meeting’s USD 200 billion annual finance figure is best described as:

A. A biodiversity resource-mobilisation goal for 2030

B. Cash fully delivered in February

C. India’s annual fiscal deficit

D. A UN peacekeeping budget

18. Cali Fund discussions concern benefit sharing associated with:

A. Nuclear fuel imports

B. Digital sequence information on genetic resources

C. Domestic income tax

D. Only petroleum extraction

19. The first EU AI Act requirements applying in February concerned, among other things:

A. Specified prohibited practices and AI literacy

B. A universal ban on machine learning

C. All future requirements simultaneously

D. Only customs duties

20. The CE20 February milestone was a:

A. Crewed lunar landing

B. Ground vacuum-ignition trial

C. Demonstration of operational nuclear propulsion

D. Successful NISAR launch

21. Euclid’s Einstein ring illustrates:

A. Radioactive decay

B. Plate subduction

C. Chemical combustion

D. Gravitational lensing

22. Why must the KM3NeT neutrino event and its February announcement be dated separately?

A. The event occurred after publication

B. The underlying detection preceded the public announcement

C. Neutrinos cannot be observed

D. All astronomy dates are arbitrary

23. The WHO Uganda development concerned:

A. Guaranteed approval of all Ebola vaccines

B. A malaria-only trial

C. Eradication of all haemorrhagic fevers

D. A Sudan-virus vaccine efficacy trial

24. A sharply falling estimated impact probability for 2024 YR4 most directly reflects:

A. Updated observations refining orbital uncertainty

B. An actual collision in February

C. Proof that all future impacts are impossible

D. An asteroid changing into a comet

25. A responsible response to AP poultry H5N1 requires:

A. Surveillance, biosecurity and evidence-based food advice

B. Ignoring animal-health authorities

C. Assuming every respiratory illness is bird flu

D. Treating all transmission routes as proved

26. The February SLBC tunnel-collapse site was in:

A. Andhra Pradesh

B. Gujarat

C. Maharashtra

D. Telangana

27. Which National Games statement is correct for the February 2025 close?

A. Only Olympic medals were counted

B. The Games were held in Germany

C. Most total medals necessarily meant first rank

D. Services led the medal-table gold count

28. Jhumoir Binandini is associated with:

A. Assam’s tea/Adivasi community culture

B. Mughal miniature painting only

C. Sikkim’s glacial lakes

D. Kerala boat races

29. The German February election should not be equated with:

A. A parliamentary electoral event

B. The immediate swearing-in of Friedrich Merz

C. A dated political snapshot

D. A result requiring coalition formation

30. A BE–RE shortfall is most useful for evaluating:

A. Astronomical distance

B. The number of Ramsar sites

C. Monetary-policy voting

D. Budget credibility and implementation assumptions

Explained answer key

1. A February brought a 25-basis-point cut to 6.25%, with a neutral stance. The 6% accommodative decision belongs to April. [FEB25-001]

2. B The release combined Q3 national accounts with the second advance estimate; estimates can later be revised. [FEB25-002]

3. D The Bill was introduced in February. Parliamentary introduction must not be confused with enactment or commencement. [FEB25-004]

4. A The pilot concerns urban land records. Surveying does not by itself settle every title dispute. [FEB25-013]

5. B The Budget proposed a conditional increase; a speech is not sufficient proof of the operative legal framework. [FEB25-023]

6. B The fiscal pipeline must be tracked stage by stage. An announced allocation is not verified spending or completion. [FEB25-046]

7. A The Makhana Board proposal was for Bihar. Parvati Arga is in UP, Aero India was at Yelahanka and SLBC is in Telangana. [FEB25-020]

8. B Completion finance addresses stalled housing; it is not an unrestricted subsidy for every housing project. [FEB25-018]

9. D The ₹25,000 crore proposal envisaged up to 49% government contribution, with other participation. [FEB25-016]

10. C The proposed mission concerns manuscript heritage, not just a modern digital literacy campaign. [FEB25-014]

11. B The February document was a draft concerning two Class X opportunities from the proposed 2026 cycle. [FEB25-007]

12. C The AP projection is a current-price state aggregate. Real growth strips out price changes and concerns a different geographical aggregate. [CA-017]

13. C The ₹12 lakh headline has regime and income-category qualifications; standard deduction is a separate mechanism. [CA-003]

14. B Article 356 concerns failure of constitutional machinery in states. The assembly was kept under suspended animation. [FEB25-026]

15. A The Court reserved judgment in February. Do not backdate the April decision. [FEB25-028]

16. D An interim stay is not a final merits decision settling every jurisdictional question. [FEB25-027]

17. A A finance target is not disbursed money. The resumed COP16 also advanced implementation and the Cali Fund. [FEB25-030]

18. B DSI benefit sharing links use of genetic information with biodiversity finance and equity. [FEB25-030]

19. A Application is phased. Selected prohibitions and literacy requirements must not be treated as universal full commencement. [FEB25-032]

20. B The trial supports engine restart capability development; a ground test is not an in-flight restart demonstration. [FEB25-033]

21. D Mass curves spacetime and can strongly lens background light; alignment can produce a ring. [FEB25-034]

22. B The exceptional event was detected earlier, in 2023, and announced in February 2025. Publication date is not detection date. [FEB25-035]

23. D A clinical efficacy trial is a research milestone, not regulatory approval or proven elimination. [FEB25-037]

24. A Risk estimates update as observations constrain the orbit. A previous probability is not a deterministic prediction. [FEB25-036]

25. A Animal, human and environmental surveillance are linked. Do not repeat unsupported blanket food bans or unproven causation. [FEB25-042]

26. D The collapse was near Domalapenta in Nagarkurnool district, Telangana; AP relevance does not change the location. [FEB25-048]

27. D Medal-table ranking is determined by golds first; total-medal leadership can differ. [FEB25-049]

28. A The event foregrounded the living culture of Assam’s tea communities. [FEB25-051]

29. B Election results, coalition agreements, parliamentary election of a chancellor and assumption of office are separate events. [FEB25-052]

30. D Budget estimates and revised estimates can reveal revenue optimism, expenditure slippage or changing conditions. [FEB25-044]

Mains answer laboratory

These are original study frameworks, not official model answers or predicted questions. Use February facts as historical evidence; check later legal status before writing a current-law answer.

1. Can a lower fiscal deficit coexist with development spending? · 250 words

Opening: Distinguish fiscal consolidation from indiscriminate expenditure reduction. Use the Union Budget’s 4.4% FY2025–26 fiscal-deficit estimate as a dated proposal.

Build: Explain revenue mobilisation, interest costs, expenditure composition, capital investment and medium-term debt sustainability. State why the quality and execution of spending matter more than allocation headlines.

Counterpoint: Cutting productive investment or essential welfare can weaken growth and future revenue; contingent liabilities can hide risk outside the headline deficit.

AP application: Compare budget estimates with revised estimates, state receipts, borrowing and capital-project execution. Central capex loans are liabilities even when terms are concessional.

Conclude: Credible assumptions, transparent liabilities, outcome evaluation and protection of high-return services reconcile fiscal prudence with development.

Avoid: Equating a budgeted allocation with money spent. References: CA-001, CA-016, FEB25-044–046.

2. What makes agricultural diversification economically sustainable? · 250 words

Opening: Introduce the Budget’s pulses, cotton, seed and high-value crop proposals as attempts to address productivity and value-chain gaps.

Build: Connect suitable agroecology, quality seed, extension, water-use efficiency, procurement confidence, storage, processing and reliable market access. Distinguish diversification of output from guaranteed diversification of income.

Counterpoint: A board, scheme or higher credit ceiling cannot remove price volatility, tenant exclusion or climate risk on its own.

AP application: Use local crop suitability, horticulture, coastal fisheries and farmer-producer organisations without assuming a Bihar-specific Makhana Board benefits all states directly.

Conclude: Encourage region-appropriate production with risk management, value addition and credible market institutions.

Avoid: Presenting proposed missions or KCC limits as universal implemented entitlements. References: CA-004–007, FEB25-019–020.

3. How can India build an inclusive digital land-record system? · 150 words

Opening: Use NAKSHA’s urban survey pilot to distinguish better information from automatic title adjudication.

Build: Explain accurate maps, linkage to existing records, public verification, accessible objections, correction mechanisms, privacy and regular updating.

Counterpoint: Technical precision can entrench an incorrect ownership record if informal occupants, women and vulnerable residents cannot contest it.

AP application: Link urban planning, municipal finance and property transactions while preserving due process and affordability of corrections.

Conclude: Technology should support accountable land administration, not replace legal safeguards.

Avoid: Claiming a drone survey conclusively settles every title. Reference: FEB25-013.

4. What should govern institutional discretion in a constitutional democracy? · 250 words

Opening: Frame the February Governor, Lokpal and election-appointment developments as questions of accountable power, not interchangeable legal disputes.

Build: Discuss constitutional text, independence, procedural fairness, reasoned action, reviewability and institutional restraint. Explain why delay can itself frustrate representative government.

Counterpoint: Judicial review must respect constitutional functions; an interim order is not a final determination of all legal issues.

AP application: Use federal accountability and legislative scrutiny as general analytical connections, not an assertion that a Tamil Nadu case arose in AP.

Conclude: Institutional autonomy requires clear procedures, transparent reasons and effective remedies.

Avoid: Backdating the April Governor judgment to February or treating an interim stay as final law. References: FEB25-025–028.

5. Is biodiversity finance only a funding-volume problem? · 250 words

Opening: Introduce the resumed CBD COP16 meeting and its resource-mobilisation discussions.

Build: Discuss predictable funding, access for developing countries, benefit sharing from digital sequence information, local community participation, safeguards, monitoring and additionality.

Counterpoint: A large finance goal can coexist with low delivery, fragmented access and weak ecological outcomes. Digital benefit sharing also raises traceability and allocation challenges.

AP application: Apply the framework to wetlands, coastal habitats and community livelihoods without claiming a particular fund has already financed an AP project.

Conclude: Transparent, equitable and ecologically effective delivery is the benchmark—not the declaration alone.

Avoid: Describing the USD 200 billion goal as cash already mobilised in February. Reference: FEB25-030.

6. What is the real test of a One Health response? · 150 words

Opening: Use confirmed poultry H5N1 reporting in AP to connect animal surveillance, human protection and environmental information.

Build: Cover farm biosecurity, rapid testing, occupational protection, reporting, coordinated veterinary/public-health action and clear risk communication.

Counterpoint: Unsupported food bans or unproven claims about migratory transmission can cause panic and damage livelihoods without improving control.

Conclude: Integrate evidence-based surveillance with compensation, trust and practical prevention.

Avoid: Assuming poultry outbreaks prove sustained human-to-human transmission. Reference: FEB25-042.

7. How should AP evaluate major irrigation and capital projects? · 250 words

Opening: Distinguish capital allocations, project construction and actual delivery of benefits.

Build: Examine financing, implementation milestones, environmental compliance, command-area readiness, operation and maintenance, and rehabilitation/resettlement.

Counterpoint: Procurement progress and completed civil works can coexist with delayed livelihood restoration or last-mile water delivery.

AP application: Use dated Polavaram and Amaravati allocations and the rehabilitation tender decision. Identify affected-family outcomes and transparent grievance redress as independent metrics.

Conclude: Evaluate projects through delivered services and fair treatment of affected people, supported by public stage-wise reporting.

Avoid: Equating a fresh tender with completed resettlement. References: FEB25-046–047.

8. How can India evaluate strategic technology progress realistically? · 150 words

Opening: Use the CE20 ground test, Euclid’s lensing image and the neutrino announcement to separate different kinds of scientific evidence.

Build: Distinguish proof of principle, ground qualification, flight validation, operational deployment and scientific discovery. Explain uncertainty, independent verification and iteration.

Counterpoint: Celebratory headlines can collapse mission stages or confuse observation dates with publication dates.

Conclude: Support sustained scientific capacity while measuring each programme against its actual technical milestone.

Avoid: Claiming the CE20 test proved an in-flight restart, or that the KM3NeT detection occurred in February 2025. References: FEB25-033–036.

Source register

Evidence access is recorded explicitly. Most non-PRS references were inspected as source extracts; primary full-text review remains open for them.

[F-PRS] PRS · February 2025 monthly review; all five chunks read

https://prsindia.org/policy/monthly-policy-review/february-2025

Full substantive web text read; linked original documents not necessarily independently read

[F-UB] PRS · Union Budget 2025–26 web analysis; both chunks read

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Full substantive web text read; linked original documents not necessarily independently read

[F-APB] PRS · AP Budget 2025–26 web analysis; both chunks read

https://prsindia.org/budgets/states/andhra-pradesh-budget-analysis-2025-26

Full substantive web text read; linked original documents not necessarily independently read

[F-SPEECH] Finance Ministry · Budget speech, 1 February; source extracts inspected

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Search-result source extract inspected; full document review pending

[F-HIGHLIGHTS] PIB · Union Budget highlights, 1 February; PDF extracts

https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2025/feb/doc202521492701.pdf

Search-result source extract inspected; full document review pending

[F-DETAIL] PIB · Budget sectoral releases, 1 February; PDF extracts

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[F-RBI] RBI · MPC resolution, 7 February; primary reference through PRS

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[F-GDP] MoSPI · Second advance estimates and Q3 GDP, 28 February; reference through PRS

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[F-CBSE] CBSE · Draft Class X examination policy, 25 February; reference through PRS

https://www.cbse.gov.in/cbsenew/documents/SCHEME_BOARD_EXAMS_POLICY_25022025.pdf

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[F-US] MEA · India–US joint statement, 13 February; through PRS

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Search-result source extract inspected; full document review pending

[F-FRANCE] MEA · India–France AI declaration, 12 February; through PRS

https://www.mea.gov.in/bilateral-documents.htm?dtl/39034/IndiaFrance_Declaration_on_Artificial_Intelligence_February_12_2025

Search-result source extract inspected; full document review pending

[F-UK] ANI · India–UK FTA negotiations resume, 24 February

https://www.bignewsnetwork.com/news/278063349/india-uk-resume-negotiations-on-free-trade-agreement

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[F-NAKSHA] PIB · NAKSHA launch preview, 17 February

https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=2104028&reg=48&lang=2

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[F-NAKSHA2] The Hindu · NAKSHA launch, 18 February

https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/naksha-project-for-urban-properties-launched-in-mysuru/article69234375.ece

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[F-CEC] CNBC-TV18 · Gyanesh Kumar assumes charge, 19 February

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[F-CE20] ISRO · 7 February CE20 vacuum ignition test; posted 8 February

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[F-EUCLID] ESA · Euclid Einstein ring around NGC6505, 10 February

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Lead and selected substantive passages inspected; not full-magazine or primary-source verification

Unfinished research

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

Daily-source reconciliation remains open for every month. Further periods remain unfinished. The monthly inventory and daily/monthly ledgers record work required, not additional completed coverage.

The automation files collect links only after deployment and enabling. No hidden researcher will fill the remaining months after this response.

Read research/Research-Status.md for corrections, exclusions, evidence caveats and close-out tasks.